



CONTINGENCY LESSONS

Reading for SylvanSync™



ANSWER KEY

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Story Summary 1

Answers

Part 1

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- My brother and I don't share a bedroom; we have separate rooms.
- "I love my haircut!" Sheila exclaimed.
- Here is our dilemma: Marc wants to ride bikes, but I want to go to the movies.

Part 2

1. a. The twins both want a puppy, and they get one for their birthday.
2. Kristin and Trevor both wished for a puppy every year on their birthday; their mom gave them hint presents this year; they chose a puppy they both loved.
3. The summary of the story includes the main idea and details listed above, and adheres to the rubric below.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
4	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Story Summary 1

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout most of the writing.
2	Addresses the topic, but focus shifts are noticeable.	Uses one detail to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate details to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Story Summary 2

Answers

Part 1

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- Fairy tales always seem to be about imprisoned princesses trying to escape.
- I was doing my homework, and my mom startled me when she knocked on my door.
- It will take a long time, but eventually I will be taller than I am today.

Part 2

1. A princess is locked away in a tower, and a prince climbs her hair to rescue her.
2. TRUE
3. The summary of the story includes the main idea and details listed above, and adheres to the rubric below.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
4	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Story Summary 2

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout most of the writing.
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1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate details to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Answers

Part 1

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- The bumps on the top of a starfish feel prickly.
- Someday I am going to invent a machine that can help people travel through time!

Part 2

1. George de Mestral invented Velcro after studying the cocklebur.
2. TRUE
3. FALSE
4. The summary of the article includes the main idea and details listed above, and adheres to the rubric below.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
4	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout most of the writing.
2	Addresses the topic, but focus shifts are noticeable.	Uses one detail to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate details to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

Answers

Part 1

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- I touched a horseshoe crab at the museum yesterday, and its shell was rough.
- I used sandpaper to smooth out the edges of a toy boat I'm making.
- My sister studies animals that might go extinct if we don't help protect them.

Part 2

1. c. Sharks are very cool animals.
2. TRUE
3. TRUE
4. The summary of the article includes the main idea and details listed above, and adheres to the rubric below.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
4	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout most of the writing.
2	Addresses the topic, but focus shifts are noticeable.	Uses one detail to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate details to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Travel Brochure

Answers

Part 1

1. a.
2. California
3. TRUE
4. Student responses may vary, but should include waterfalls, birds, and nature.

Part 2

The student's list should include some great things about their hometown, such as museums, natural beauty, fun places to eat or visit, etc.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 1–2

Travel Brochure

Part 3

The student's brochure should advertise their hometown, have illustrations of attractions there, and adhere to the rubric below.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
4	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.
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Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Character Portrait

Answers

Part 1

1. man
2. a. cowboy
3. Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:
 - I think he is feeling angry or sad because he is not smiling.
4. TRUE

Part 2

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- He is a cowboy.
- He looks sad or angry.
- Maybe he lost his horse.
- He is married.
- He wears a wedding ring.
- He has a hat on.
- He has a moustache.
- He is wearing a coat; it must be cold outside.
- He looks old.
- I think he spends a lot of time alone.
- I wonder why he is grumpy.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Character Portrait

Part 3

The character description should include the details listed in the map, and can be graded based on the rubric below.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
4	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.
3	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout most of the writing.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Character Portrait

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
2	Addresses the topic, but focus shifts are noticeable.	Uses one detail to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate details to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Funny Story

Answers

Part 2

1. YES
2. Dogs always use their noses to ask questions.
3. YES
4. YES
5. Student responses may vary, but should describe something funny from the excerpt from Doctor Dolittle.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Funny Story

Part 3

Student responses may vary, but should include brainstormed ideas about the humorous incident, characters, and story line.

The student's story should tell about something funny and adhere to the rubric below.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
4	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.
3	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout most of the writing.
2	Addresses the topic, but focus shifts are noticeable.	Uses one detail to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate details to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Comparative Literature

Answers

Part 2

1. d. It is right to help those who help you.
2. c. Even a small friend can help a larger one.
3. Student responses may vary, but should note that both fables are about being helpful to others, or that size doesn't matter when it comes to helping others.

Part 3

Student responses may vary, but should include brainstormed ideas about the student's moral, characters, and story line.

Student's fable should have animal characters, convey a moral, adhere to the rubric below, and include an illustration.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
4	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Comparative Literature

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout most of the writing.
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Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 3–5

Story Summary 2

Answers

Part 1

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- The doctor said that Jane's condition will improve after she takes the new medicine.
- When my brother asked for my advice on his problem, I thought about it seriously before I answered.
- I thought the animals at the farm were well fed—they didn't look scrawny to me.

Part 2

1. A poor man thinks his life is very bad, but he soon realizes it could be worse.
2. a. true
3. a. true
4. The summary of the story includes the main idea and details listed above, and adheres to the rubric below.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
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Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Story Summary 2

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Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Answers

Part 1

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- I play the violin and have to practice a lot, and I think it must be very hard to improvise.
- When the band gets going, their chords make beautiful music.
- I'm not a very good dancer because I can't always hear the rhythm in the music.

Part 2

1. d. Jazz music has a very interesting history and is still popular today.
2. a. true
3. b. false
4. The summary of the article includes the main idea and details listed above, and adheres to the rubric below.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
4	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
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Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

Answers

Part 1

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- I wonder what the nucleus of a comet looks like up close!
- My teacher told me that the part of the comet we can see in the sky is its coma.
- The moon orbits the Earth, and the Earth orbits the sun.

Part 2

1. d. Comets are interesting features of the night sky.
2. b. false
3. a. true
4. The summary of the article includes the main idea and details listed above, and adheres to the rubric below.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
4	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
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Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Drama

Answers

Part 2

1. Mother Bear, Father Bear, Sonny Bear, and Goldilocks. I can tell because their names appear before the words they speak.
2. Those are stage directions. The character is supposed to act the way they direct.
3. a. true
4. a. true
5. Student responses may vary, but should say that the Bear Family is worried but glad the girl has left.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 3–5

Drama

Part 4

Scenes will vary, but should have some of the same characters and be about roughly the same theme/plot as the scene presented here, and should conform to the rubric below.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
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Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Poem

Answers

Part 2

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- **Alliteration** Flute twitters a tune
 - **Assonance** The cymbals crash like a lightning flash
 - **Onomatopoeia** Violin cries, zin zone
 - **Personification** while bass gives off sad moans
 - **Simile** The cymbals crash like a lightning flash
1. Student responses may vary.
 2. Student responses may vary.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 3–5

Poem

Part 3

Student should brainstorm ideas for a poem.

Poems should contain some figurative language, and may be judged loosely on the rubric below, with the understanding that poetry cannot be held to the same standards as prose writing.

Writing Rubric

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Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Science Fiction

Answers**Part 2**

1. b. Something strange was coming out of the ground.
2. at a park
3. b. false
4. Student responses may vary, but should include the thing that screws out of the hole it made in the ground, and the grayish creatures with tentacles.

Part 3

The student's example of a science fiction story should take place in another place or time, and include scientific or technological advances that make the setting/experiences very different from life as we know it today. It should adhere to rubric below.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
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Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Science Fiction

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
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1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate details to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Realistic Fiction

Answers

Part 2

1. Student responses may vary, but the general idea should be, yes, this story could happen.
2. flashlight, computer games, and wedding pictures
3. a. true
4. Student responses may vary. Students might suggest relocating the story to a neighbor's backyard to make it more realistic.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 3–5

Realistic Fiction

Part 3

Student responses may vary, but students should use the space to brainstorm their ideas about a piece of realistic fiction.

Stories should be graded based on how realistic they are and with the rubric below.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
4	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.
3	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout most of the writing.
2	Addresses the topic, but focus shifts are noticeable.	Uses one detail to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate details to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Travel Brochure

Answers

Part 1

1. c. Feel the rumble under your feet as a moose runs by.
2. bears; moose; fish
3. a. true
4. Student responses may vary, but could include ocean sightings, animal sightings, and fall foliage.

Part 2

The student's list should include some great things about their hometown, such as museums, natural beauty, fun places to eat or visit, etc.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 3–5

Travel Brochure

Part 3

The student's brochures should advertise their hometown, have illustrations of attractions there, and adhere to the rubric below.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
4	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.
3	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout most of the writing.
2	Addresses the topic, but focus shifts are noticeable.	Uses one detail to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate details to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling.

Reading for SylvanSync™ Grades 3–5 Comparative Literature

Answers

Part 3

1. c. a story describing things a tornado could not do in real life
2. b. an encyclopedia of weather
3. b. false
4. a. true
5. Student responses may vary.
6. Essay should address the different ways each piece of writing made the student feel, and should adhere to the rubric below.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
4	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.
3	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few details to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout most of the writing.
2	Addresses the topic, but focus shifts are noticeable.	Uses one detail to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate details to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Story Summary 1

Answers

Part 1

1. b. false
2. a. true
3. a. true
4. b. false
5. a. true

Part 2

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- This seems like a summary since it includes a main idea. It does include one important event. It is concise without needless words or repetitions. The conclusion is at the end of the summary.
- The summary does omit the title of the story and the author's name. It might have been more interesting, though, if it provided a bit more description of the girl and where they were living. The summary doesn't really answer the where and who questions.

Part 3

1. a. People's good qualities should be respected by others.
2. a. The story describes imaginary events.
3. d. Wizard
4. a. He will ask for the Wizard to help him.
5. c. occur

Part 4

Student flash cards and crossword puzzle may vary.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Story Summary 1

Part 5

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Summary Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses all characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the summary.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the summary.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of a summary.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the summary.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Story Summary 2

Answers

Part 1

1. b. false
2. a. true
3. a. true
4. b. false
5. a. true

Part 2

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- This seems like a summary since it includes a main idea. It does include one important event. It is concise without needless words or repetitions. The conclusion is at the end of the summary.
- The summary does omit the title of the story and the author's name. It might have been more interesting, though, if it provided a bit more description of the girl and where they were living. The summary doesn't really answer the where and who questions.

Part 3

1. d. It is important to understand the possible results of your actions.
2. a. The story describes imaginary characters.
3. b. Epimetheus
4. d. She will put the object in a place that it is not visible.
5. a. to strain mentally

Part 4

Student flash cards and word search may vary.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Story Summary 2

Part 5

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Summary Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses all characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the summary.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the summary.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of a summary.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the summary.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Answers**Part 1**

1. b. false
2. a. true
3. a. true
4. b. false
5. a. true

Part 2

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- This seems like it is a summary since it does include the main idea of the original article which probably is the changes in hockey. It does include the important ideas. It is concise without needless words or repetitions. The conclusion is at the end of the summary.
- The summary does omit the title of the article and the author's name. It is not clear whether or not the introductory sentence is the main idea or the author's opinion who wrote the summary.

Part 3

1. b. Lacrosse has a long history in North America.
2. a. The article includes factual information.
3. c. French
4. d. People will enjoy participating in lacrosse as they learn to play it.
5. b. history

Part 4

Student flash cards may vary.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Part 5

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Summary Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses all characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the summary.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the summary.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of a summary.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the summary.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

Answers

Part 1

1. b. False
2. a. True
3. a. True
4. b. False
5. a. True

Part 2

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- This seems like it is a summary since it does include a main idea. It does include some important ideas. It is concise without needless words or repetitions. The conclusion is at the end of the summary.
- The summary does omit the title of the article and the author's name. The introductory sentence is probably not the main idea of the article.

Part 3

1. b. Mars, its moons, and its exploration are explained.
2. b. The article includes factual information.
3. b. 1976
4. c. Scientists will be able to determine more about minerals in the ground.
5. c. unlike

Part 4

Student flash cards may vary.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

Part 5

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Summary Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses all characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the summary.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the summary.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of a summary.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the summary.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Drama

Answers

Part 1

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- Stage directions: (*The front door to the store opens. Karz enters from the street.*)
- Character: Claypoole
- Dialogue: Can't you see that I'm busy?
- Setting: *The interior of Steele's Antiques Store after 8:00 pm.*
- Conflict: We could argue about price all evening, Mr. Claypoole, but the fact remains that you want this table.

Part 2

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

1. It allows the reader to “see” that the character has changed her tone.
2. It provides information to the reader as to the setting of the scene.
3. These are the three characters that will be in the play.
4. Each line indicates the conversation or dialogue that is spoken by the character.
5. Conflict in a play provides the struggle of the main characters, and this moves the plot forward.

Part 3

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

1. It is late and all of them are tired and would like to go home.
2. A table would be in the center, and there would be a number of pieces of old furniture and other antiques.
3. The time period and the location of the antique store could be added.
4. This guy must think that I don't know what I am selling!
5. In Scene Two, Claypoole will not be able to take the table out of the store to his car in four minutes.

Part 4

The student should be able to read the scene orally with expression.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Drama

Part 5

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's scene.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Structure of the Scene	Uses Features of a Play Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the structure of the scene exactly.	Uses many of the appropriate features of a play in the scene.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the scene.
2	Does a good job of targeting the structure of the scene but wanders a bit.	Uses a few appropriate features of a play.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the scene.
1	Does not address the structure of the scene at all.	Does not use appropriate features of a play.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the scene.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Op-Ed Essay

Answers
Part 1

Facts	Opinions
2	1
3	4
6	5
9	7
10	8

Part 2

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- sandy
- sunny and hot
- The best vacation spot is always one where there are lots of things to do for everyone in the family.
- A vacation at the beach can be too expensive and too crowded.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Op-Ed Essay

Part 3

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

1. I finished the homework assignment within five minutes.
2. All of the author's writing has been awarded prizes.
3. I find studying poetry to be difficult, but I find studying drama to be exciting.
4. I believe expecting students to read 25 novels this year is unacceptable.
5. A new writer has never won the writing contest.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Op-Ed Essay

Part 4

Opinions	Facts
The school day is entirely too long.	Many students must be at school as early as 7:30 in the morning.
...perhaps it is the instruction that needs to change and not the length of the school day.	School days for many students run as long as eight hours.
I propose that the school day be shortened instead.	Government officials are talking about extending the school day so that more subjects can be added.
We will all be better off if we produce well-balanced children rather than children who are suffocated by our school systems.	Children have 12 years of schooling.

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- The writer does not sufficiently support the argument that the school day should be shortened. There are many opinions but not sufficient facts to support that a longer school day will hurt students. The facts don't really show any evidence that a long school day leads to less learning or harms students.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Op-Ed Essay

Part 5

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate facts to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few facts to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate facts to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Blog

Answers

Part 1

1. b. false
2. a. true
3. a. true
4. b. false
5. b. false

Part 2

1. d. People should learn the basics of a sport.
2. c. Nikki
3. b. She will book another kayak adventure.
4. a. authorized representative
5. d. by explaining her fear and how she overcame it

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Blog

Part 3

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Summary Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses all characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the summary.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the summary.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of a summary.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the summary.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Blog

Part 4

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Structure of a blog	Uses Persuasive Techniques Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the structure of the blog exactly.	Uses a persuasive technique in the blog.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the blog.
2	Does a good job of targeting the structure of the blog but wanders a bit.	Uses some of the persuasive technique in the blog.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the blog.
1	Does not address the structure of the blog at all.	Does not use a persuasive technique in the blog.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the blog.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Print Advertisement

Answers

Part 1

1. Glittering Generalities
2. Card Stacking
3. Transfer
4. Testimonial
5. Plain Folks
6. Loaded Words
7. Bandwagon

Part 2

1. Bandwagon: Everyone
2. Plain Folk: Just like you
3. Loaded Words: Intense, Amazing, Incredible

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Print Advertisement

Part 3

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Structure of the Advertisement	Uses Persuasive Techniques Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the structure of the advertisement exactly.	Uses a persuasive technique in the advertisement.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the advertisement.
2	Does a good job of targeting the structure of the advertisement but wanders a bit.	Uses some of the persuasive technique in the advertisement.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the advertisement.
1	Does not address the structure of the advertisement at all.	Does not use a persuasive technique in the advertisement.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the advertisement.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Print Advertisement

Part 4

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- My advertisement uses the same persuasive technique as the second advertisement, but my pictures will draw in the audience better than the old-fashioned pictures in the original ad.
- In my advertisement I used two persuasive techniques while the original advertisement only uses one.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Poem

Answers

Part 1

1. onomatopoeia
2. personification
3. simile
4. idiom
5. alliteration
6. hyperbole
7. metaphor

Part 2

1. onomatopoeia
2. The poet is trying to get the reader to hear the sounds of the bells.
3. Poe is showing how things change from season to season or from one stage of life to the next.

Part 3

1. personification
2. The poet is trying to get the reader to visualize the beauty and importance of the purple flower to the insects and birds by giving them all human personality traits.
3. All aspects of nature are interrelated and important as they grow and change throughout the seasons.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Poem

Part 4

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

1. Simile: He was as tall as a skyscraper.
2. Metaphor: His has the voice of a wolf.
3. Personification: The sun smiled brightly at us in the morning.
4. Idiom: That computer cost us an arm and a leg.
5. Hyperbole: Her eyes were as wide as saucers.
6. Alliteration: The shining sun smiled suddenly from behind the clouds.
7. Onomatopoeia: The bee buzzed by my head.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Poem

Part 5

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's poem.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Structure of the Poem	Uses Figurative Language Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the structure of the poem exactly.	Uses several appropriate examples of figurative language in the poem.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the poem.
2	Does a good job of targeting the structure of the poem but wanders a bit.	Uses a few appropriate examples of figurative language in the poem.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the poem.
1	Does not address the structure of the poem at all.	Does not use appropriate examples of figurative language in the poem.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Science Fiction

Answers**Part 1**

1. b. false
2. b. false
3. a. true
4. a. true
5. a. true

Part 2

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- Notes:
 - o Planetary collision
 - o Martian astronomers
- 1. The unusual occurrence of planets colliding and the Martian astronomers.
- 2. They thought they could see outlines of some sort of creature that was looking down at them from Mars. It appeared that the creatures had some type of machine that was controlling the events in the sky.
- 3. d. The earth and its people were forever changed by a collision of planets.
- 4. d. It was hit by a new planet.
- 5. a. outer space astronomers

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Science Fiction

Part 3

Setting: Where: all over earth
When: in the past
Major Characters: people of earth Minor Characters: Martians
Plot/Problem: The earth looks like it is going to be hit by a burning star.
Event 1: Neptune is hit by a new planet.
Event 2: The star grew in size and was rapidly approaching earth.
Event 3: The star missed earth but caused great destruction.
Outcome: Earth changed but life went on.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Science Fiction

Part 4

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the writing.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Realistic Fiction

Answers

Part 1

1. b. false
2. b. false
3. a. true
4. a. true

Part 2

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- Notes:
 - creek
 - experienced rafters
 - Ryan was only five feet tall
 - Austin was almost five feet, eight inches tall
- 1. The characters could actually exist, and they have an experience that others might actually have.
- 2. Lots of people run these rapids every day. Don't be chicken!
- 3. c. He ducks down into the bottom of the raft.
- 4. d. Not being an experienced rafter, Ryan thought it looked dangerous.
- 5. c. He will make sure that they go to a different part of the creek with fewer rapids.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Realistic Fiction

Part 3

Setting: Where: in a creek When: Probably in the spring or summer, since the creek is racing and high.
Major Characters: Austin and Ryan Minor Characters: none
Plot/Problem: Austin is fearful of paddling the raft through the dangerous rapids.
Event 1: The boys put the raft into the creek.
Event 2: The boys approach the rapids. Austin ducks down and quits paddling.
Event 3: Ryan maneuvers the raft through the rapids and paddles to shore.
Outcome: The two boys think that they conquered the Power Plant.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Realistic Fiction

Part 4

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the writing.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Travel Brochure

Answers**Part 1**

1. Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:
 - Sight-countryside, architecture, mountains, museums
 - Smell-garlic and butter, spicy meats, and fresh berries
 - Touch-soothing water
 - Taste-food
 - Sound-bells, music
2. visual
3. It was used the most so that the reader can “see” the potential things there are to see during the trip to Europe.

Part 2

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- The scent of fresh coffee will lead you into the cafes.
- The sounds of the many different languages are thrilling.

Part 3

1. a. The logger spotted the gnarled tree towering over the others.
2. a. They cautiously approached the darkened crumbling house.
3. b. They ate the hot buttery popcorn as they watched the movie.
4. b. We played roughly and were scolded loudly by the stern teacher.
5. a. Swiftly I flew down the mountainside on my cool snowboard.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Travel Brochure

Part 4

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

Favorite Vacation Spot: Beach

Sense	Details
Visual / See	children playing in the sand
	sunburned people lying on the beach
	sparkling sand
	white-speckled shells
	water and the blue sky
Sounds	children laughing
	parents chattering
	lifeguard's warning whistle
	lapping of the waves
	swimmers splashing
Tastes	salt water
	hot dogs
	sand
	ice cream
	watermelon
Textures / Touch	sunburned skin
	sun on my face
	gritty sand between my fingers
	wet towel
	rough stones
Smells	fresh air
	fish
	suntan lotion
	hot dogs
	seaweed

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Travel Brochure

Part 5

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Structure of the Travel Brochure	Uses Details Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the structure of the travel brochure exactly.	Uses many appropriate details in the travel brochure.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the travel brochure.
2	Does a good job of targeting the structure of the travel brochure but wanders a bit.	Uses some details in the travel brochure.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the travel brochure.
1	Does not address the structure of the travel brochure at all.	Does not use details in the travel brochure.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the travel brochure.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Movie Review

Answers

Part 1

1. a. true
2. b. false
3. a. true
4. a. true

Part 2

1. d. *Harry Potter and the Deathly Hallows: Part 1* is an excellent film.
2. d. fantasy
3. d. the character development of Harry Potter and his friends
4. d. four stars out of five

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Movie Review

Part 3

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

Claims	Supporting Details
This installment is craftily directed by the English filmmaker David Yates.	He has directed the final four films of the Harry Potter series. All of these became instant blockbusters.
The director has everything in the movie that needs to be there.	none
It is a bit slow.	none
Oddly, there are fewer special effects and virtually none of the usual Hogwarts backdrops.	none
The strength of the movie was in the cinematography.	mostly dark, menacing, and generally scary
the major weakness of the movie	If you're not a die-hard Harry Potter book series fan you will not understand the setting and problems in the film.

1. The reviewer does make a number of unsupported claims. Those that are supported are not supported with specific details from the movie itself. There are too many generalities.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Movie Review

Part 4

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

1. The reviewer only includes one event of the plot in the first paragraph. The reviewer must be assuming that the readers of the review are familiar with the Harry Potter books and movies. The review doesn't provide enough elements of the plot to make this a successful review.
2. The review is written in an enthusiastic and positive tone in a rather casual but informative style.
3. The reviewer does not clearly establish his or her credibility. I can assume that the reviewer has seen some of the previous movies and read at least this book and maybe others.
4. The reviewer did not include how the music supports the mood of the movie, how long the movie is, and more description of how the three characters interact in this installment.
5. I would like to know how this movie connects to the others in the series and get a clue as to how it connects to the final installment.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Movie Review

Part 5

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the writing.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Music Review

Answers

Part 1

1. a. true
2. b. false
3. b. false
4. b. false
5. a. true

Part 2

1. d. pop
2. d. “Start Over”
3. b. “I Miss You”
4. d. four stars out of five

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Music Review

Part 3

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

Claims	Supporting Details
Her vocals have improved vastly since the last release.	None
Production is smart, smooth but varied.	Among the producers and writers were not just old hands such as Rodney Jerkins and Tricky Stewart, but Frank Ocean of Odd Future, MIA producers Diplo and Switch, and Sleigh Bells.
I loved most of the tracks the first time I heard them, but some might have to grow on you.	None
There's a track for just about anyone here.	The reviewer supports this with classifying the music into three major categories.
Thus album, however, is not dark.	None

1. The reviewer does make a number of unsupported claims. Only two of the claims are supported but these are supported with enough evidence to make the reader want to purchase the CD.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Music Review

Part 4

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

1. The reviewer mentioned 9 of the 13 tracks on the CD but there is never a discussion that specifically details why two or three of the songs are best and why one or two of the songs just aren't that good.
2. The review is written in an enthusiastic and positive tone. The style is rather casual but informative.
3. The reviewer does not clearly establish his or her credibility. I can assume that the reviewer has listened to some of the previous CDs but there are no specific references to them.
4. The reviewer did not include the number of tracks, total playing time, and where Beyoncé will be performing concerts.
5. I would like to know how this CD is a change for Beyoncé from her prior CDs. It would also be more convincing to buy if I knew where it is on the pop-charts.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Music Review

Part 5

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the writing.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Compare Genres / Themes

Answers**Part 1**

d short story

a poem

e folktale

b personal narrative

c play

Part 2

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

1. A play is written with dialogue and is to be acted by performers on a stage. A poem usually does not have dialogue and is not performed.
2. A short story is fictional and a personal narrative is about an actual experience that the writer had.
3. Both stories are fictional and are fun to read.
4. Both literary forms are fictional and have been told to others to help explain something.
5. Both are nonfiction and tell the story of a person's life and experiences. A biography is written by another person and an autobiography is written by the actual person.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Compare Genres / Themes

Part 3

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

1. a story about a person who steals and gets caught in the end
2. a story about people who have many struggles together but they keep working together as a team and finally achieve their goals
3. a story of student whose parents have told her that if there is something that is wrong, she should let others know that what they are doing is wrong
4. a poem with a character of a little animal that helps others
5. a fable with a character who learns that not doing what he says he is going to do makes people not believe in him

Part 4

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

1. They both focus on people's feelings. The poem is written to bring alive the feeling of hope through painting a picture, but the short story develops hope through events, people's actions, and conversation.
2. The theme is how hope can help people in different situations and what hope is. Both literary forms portray hope as a positive aspect of life.
3. The poem develops the theme of hope through using personification to bring the feeling of hope alive. In the story there is only one example of a person's experiencing hope for her future.
4. I like the poem better because it paints a picture for me as to how hope can help a person in many different situations.
5. I hoped that in the end you would all understand and respect my wishes and I can see that it has happened.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Compare Genres / Themes

Part 5

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Structure of the Literary Form	Develops Theme Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the structure of the literary form exactly.	Develops the theme in the literary form.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the literary form.
2	Does a good job of targeting the structure of the literary form but wanders a bit.	Partially develops a theme in the literary form.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the literary form.
1	Does not address the structure of the literary form at all.	Does not develop any theme in the literary form.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling literary form.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Story Summary 1

Answers

Part 1

1. a. true
2. a. true
3. b. false
4. b. false

Part 2

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- This appears to be a summary since it includes a main idea. It does include one important event. It is concise without needless words or repetitions. The conclusion is at the end of the summary.
- The summary does omit the title and author's name of the passage. It might have been more interesting, though, if it provided a bit more description of the girl and where they were living. The summary doesn't really answer the where and who questions.

Part 3

1. d. A person can become very saddened by the loss of someone.
2. a. The passage includes imagined details and people.
3. c. He will participate in the imaginary homecoming event.
4. b. to walk heavily

Part 4

Student flash cards and crossword puzzle may vary.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Story Summary 1

Part 5

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Summary Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses all characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the summary.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the summary.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of a summary.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the summary.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Story Summary 2

Answers

Part 1

1. a. true
2. a. true
3. b. false
4. b. false

Part 2

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- This appears to be a summary since it includes a main idea. It does include one important event. It is concise without needless words or repetitions. The conclusion is at the end of the summary.
- The summary does omit the title and author's name of the passage. It might have been more interesting though if it provided a bit more description of the girl and where they were living. The summary doesn't really answer the where and who questions.

Part 3

1. d. It is important to enjoy each phase of life and the people you encounter.
2. a. The passage includes imaginary details and people.
3. b. 4
4. c. He will be patient, gentle, with his family members just like his grandfather.
5. d. without effect

Part 4

Student flash cards and word search may vary.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Story Summary 2

Part 5

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Summary Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses all characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the summary.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the summary.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of a summary.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the summary.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Answers**Part 1**

1. b. false
2. a. true
3. a. true
4. b. false
5. a. true

Part 2

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- This seems like it is a summary since it does include the main idea of the original article which probably is the changes in hockey. It does include the important ideas. It is concise without needless words or repetitions. The conclusion is at the end of the summary.
- The summary does omit the title of the article and the author's name. It is not clear whether or not the introductory sentence is the main idea or the author's opinion who wrote the summary.

Part 3

1. c. history of the changes in the utilization of the Saint Bernard
2. b. The article includes factual information.
3. b. monks
4. d. The size and tenacity of the breed allows it to be legendary.
5. c. travelers

Part 4

Student flash cards may vary.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Part 5

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Summary Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses all characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the summary.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the summary.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of a summary.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the summary.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

Answers

Part 1

1. b. false
2. a. true
3. a. true
4. b. false
5. a. true

Part 2

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- This seems like it is a summary since it does include a main idea. It does include some important ideas. It is concise without needless words or repetitions. The conclusion is at the end of the summary.
- The summary does omit the title of the article and the author's name. The introductory sentence is probably not the main idea of the article.

Part 3

1. d. Elephants' characteristics are fascinating but put them at risk of extinction.
2. b. The article includes factual information.
3. d. 75%
4. c. The population of elephants in the wild will continue to decline.
5. b. chewing

Part 4

Student flash cards may vary.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

Part 5

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Summary Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses all characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the summary.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the summary.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of a summary.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the summary.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 9–12

Drama

Answers

Part 1

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- Stage directions: *(Goes over and takes a sandwich.)*
- Character: Algernon Moncrieff
- Dialogue: It isn't Ernest; it's Jack.
- Setting: *Morning-room in Algernon's flat in Half-Moon Street. The room is luxuriously and artistically furnished. The sound of a piano is heard in the adjoining room.*
- Conflict: I am afraid Aunt Augusta won't quite approve of your being here.

Part 2

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

1. It allows the reader to “hear” the character’s tone in his voice.
2. It provides information to the reader as to the setting of the scene.
3. These are the characters that will be in the play.
4. Each line indicates the conversation or dialogue that is spoken by the character.
5. Conflict in a play provides the struggle of the main characters, and this moves the plot forward.

Part 3

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

1. This play is probably set back in the 1800s when people had servants, and Algernon is arrogant and not respectful to his servants.
2. A sofa, table, chairs, paintings, and rugs might be found in the setting.
3. It could have something that indicates that the new arrivals are coming into the room and they are surprised to see Jack.
4. This guy must think that he is a professional, but it is quite dreadful like the sound of a screeching cat!
5. In Scene Two, Jack will make a proposal of marriage.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 9–12

Drama

Part 4

The student should be able to read the scene orally with expression.

Part 5

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's scene.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Structure of the Scene	Use Features of a Play Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the structure of the scene exactly.	Uses many of the appropriate features of a play in the scene.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the scene.
2	Does a good job of targeting the structure of the scene but wanders a bit.	Uses a few appropriate features of a play.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the scene.
1	Does not address the structure of the scene at all.	Does not use appropriate features of a play.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the scene.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Op-Ed Essay

Answers

Part 1

Facts	Opinions
2	1
3	4
6	5
9	7
10	8

Part 2

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- snowy
- windy and cold
- The best vacation spot is always one where there are lots of things to do for everyone in the family.
- A ski vacation can be too expensive and too crowded.

Part 3

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

1. The required assignment was extremely difficult.
2. The lectures would focus on ancient art.
3. I think the lecturers are brilliant.
4. Each speaker was extremely boring.
5. According to an audience survey, the third speaker was voted the most inspiring.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Op-Ed Essay

Part 4

Opinions	Facts
I say it because new knowledge and hard experience argue persuasively that both our programs and our institutions in America need to be reformed.	1970 marks the beginning of a new decade in which America will celebrate its 200th birthday.
The moment has arrived to harness the vast energies and abundance of this land to the creation of a new American experience, an experience richer and deeper and more truly a reflection of the goodness and grace of the human spirit.	Occasionally there comes a time when profound and far-reaching events command a break with tradition.
The seventies will be a time of new beginnings, a time of exploring both on the earth and in the heavens, a time of discovery.	

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- The speaker does not sufficiently support the argument that this is a time for change. There are many opinions but there are not sufficient facts to support that this is a time for change.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Op-Ed Essay

Part 5

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate facts to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few facts to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate facts to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Blog

Answers

Part 1

1. b. false
2. a. true
3. a. true
4. b. false
5. b. false

Part 2

1. d. Being a vegetarian is healthful—and is not as difficult as it first appears.
2. d. buy packages of prepared vegetables
3. a. vegetarian recipes
4. d. strong desire
5. c. by explaining how he personally is making changes to his diet

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 9–12

Blog

Part 3

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Summary Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses all characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the summary.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the summary.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of a summary.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the summary.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 9–12

Blog

Part 4

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Structure of a blog	Uses Persuasive Techniques Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the structure of the blog exactly.	Uses a persuasive technique in the blog.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the blog.
2	Does a good job of targeting the structure of the blog but wanders a bit.	Uses some of the persuasive technique in the blog.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the blog.
1	Does not address the structure of the blog at all.	Does not use a persuasive technique in the blog.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the blog.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Print Advertisement

Answers

Part 1

1. Glittering Generalities
2. Card Stacking
3. Transfer
4. Testimonial
5. Plain Folks
6. Loaded Words
7. Bandwagon

Part 2

1. Bandwagon: You too; and Testimonial: All Gold-Medal Winners
2. Plain Folk: Just like you, down-to-earth language
3. Loaded Words: same old, Most Amazing, Incredible

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Print Advertisement

Part 3

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Structure of the Advertisement	Uses Persuasive Techniques Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the structure of the advertisement exactly.	Uses a persuasive technique in the advertisement.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the advertisement.
2	Does a good job of targeting the structure of the advertisement but wanders a bit.	Uses some of the persuasive technique in the advertisement.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the advertisement.
1	Does not address the structure of the advertisement at all.	Does not use a persuasive technique in the advertisement.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the advertisement.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Print Advertisement

Part 4

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- My advertisement uses the same persuasive technique as the second advertisement, but my advertisement uses color so it is more convincing than the black and white advertisements.
- In my advertisement I used two persuasive techniques while the original advertisement only uses one.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Poem

Answers

Part 1

1. onomatopoeia
2. personification
3. simile
4. idiom
5. alliteration
6. hyperbole
7. metaphor

Part 2

1. personification
2. The poet is creating a description for the reader of the power of the moon over the ocean to create tides.
3. Dickinson is describes the power of love to gently guide and to obey at the same time.

Part 3

1. simile
2. The poet is comparing the freshness and energy of the phase of youth with the warmth and renewal of the sun during the summer.
3. Shakespeare is drawing comparisons between two phases of life.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Poem

Part 4

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

1. Simile: He was as tall as a skyscraper.
2. Metaphor: His has a voice of a wolf.
3. Personification: The sun smiled brightly at us in the morning.
4. Idiom: That computer cost us an arm and a leg.
5. Hyperbole: Her eyes were as wide as saucers.
6. Alliteration: The shining sun smiled suddenly from behind the clouds.
7. Onomatopoeia: The bee buzzed by my head.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 9–12

Poem

Part 5

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's poem.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Structure of the Poem	Uses Figurative Language Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the structure of the poem exactly.	Uses several appropriate examples of figurative language in the poem.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the poem.
2	Does a good job of targeting the structure of the poem but wanders a bit.	Uses a few appropriate examples of figurative language in the poem.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the poem.
1	Does not address the structure of the poem at all.	Does not use appropriate examples of figurative language in the poem.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Science Fiction

Answers**Part 1**

1. b. false
2. b. false
3. a. true
4. a. true
5. a. true

Part 2

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- Notes:
 - o time machine and it was gone—vanished
 - o The invention of a time machine and the demonstration of it disappearing.
- 1. Looking at the quartz I seemed to see a face staring back at me as though it was studying me. Looking at the drawings, I saw the outline of what I was seeing in the quartz.
- 2. a. Time travel is proposed and is demonstrated.
- 3. c. The demonstration of the time machine
- 4. c. The Time Traveler will test his machine and disappear only to return again.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 9–12

Science Fiction

Part 3

Setting: Where: the house (or lab) of the Time Traveler
When: in the past, at night
Major Characters: The Time Traveler
Minor Characters: Very Young Man, Mayor, Medical Man, Psychologist, and Filby
Plot/Problem: The Time Traveler is explaining the possibility of traveling through time.
Event 1: Time Traveler explains why he thinks mathematics and science are wrong in terms of the four dimensions.
Event 2: The Time Traveler demonstrates his small time travel model.
Event 3: The model disappears and everyone is shocked and amazed at the same time.
Outcome: The Time Traveler produces his actual machine that he will travel in at some point in the future.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Science Fiction

Part 4

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the writing.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Realistic Fiction

Answers**Part 1**

1. b. false
2. b. false
3. a. true
4. a. true

Part 2

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- Notes:
 - midland plain of North America
 - I was ten years old.
 - Virginia
 - Nebraska
- 1. The characters could actually exist and they have an experience that others might actually have.
- 2. My world experience has only included travel to school, the Saturday Farmer's Market, church on Sunday, and other mountain towns within a radius of 100 miles.
- 3. a. A young boy leaves his family home and travels west.
- 4. c. This last remark made me bashful, and I shook my head.
- 5. c. The narrator will meet his grandparents and begin to experience a farm in Nebraska.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 9–12

Realistic Fiction

Part 3

Setting: Where: on a train and in a truck
When: during the day and night
Major Characters: Narrator Minor Characters: Jake Marpole, conductor, Antonia, Otto Fuchs, the immigrant family
Plot/Problem: Narrator has lost his parents and is being sent to Nebraska to live.
Event 1: The explanation to the reader as to why the narrator is leaving on the train.
Event 2: The narrator's experiences on the train.
Event 3: The narrator's trip by truck in the night to his new home.
Outcome: Not sure since this is just the first part of the story, but the outcome at this point is the feeling of sadness in the narrator.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 9–12

Realistic Fiction

Part 4

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the writing.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Travel Brochure

Answers**Part 1**

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- Sight- Panama Canal, islands, blue waters, white sand, coves
 - Smell- fried Yucca root and tamales
 - Touch- warm salt water, warm air
 - Taste-food
 - Sound-lapping waves
1. visual
 2. It is used the most so that the reader can “see” what it is they will experience during the trip.

Part 2

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

- The aromas from the foods will entice you.
- The smell of the ocean is one that you won't forget during your next snowstorm at home.

Part 3

1. a. Eduardo has become renowned worldwide due to his creative and inventive art.
2. b. Prescient weather forecasters predict that this will be another wickedly torrid summer.
3. b. Heated words spun out of his mouth like a rapidly rotating whirlwind inflicting grief and pain on those who crossed his path.
4. a. The larks' songs are the sounds of flutes creating an ethereal quality that is both tranquil and delightful.
5. b. The valiant knave bowed before the monarch in knightly submission as the pealing of the bells could be heard in the distance.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 9–12

Travel Brochure

Part 4

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

Favorite Vacation Spot: Beach

Sense	Details
Visual / See	children playing in the sand
	sunburned people lying on the beach
	sparkling sand
	white-speckled shells
	water and the blue sky
Sounds	children laughing
	parents chattering
	lifeguard's warning whistle
	lapping of the waves
	swimmers splashing
Tastes	salt water
	hot dogs
	sand
	ice cream
	watermelon
Textures / Touch	sunburned skin
	sun on my face
	gritty sand between my fingers
	wet towel
	rough stones
Smells	fresh air
	fish
	suntan lotion
	hot dogs
	rotting plants

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 9–12

Travel Brochure

Part 5

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Structure of the Travel Brochure	Uses Details Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the structure of the travel brochure exactly.	Uses many appropriate details in the travel brochure.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the travel brochure.
2	Does a good job of targeting the structure of the travel brochure but wanders a bit.	Uses some details in the travel brochure.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the travel brochure.
1	Does not address the structure of the travel brochure at all.	Does not use details in the travel brochure.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the travel brochure.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 9–12

Movie Review

Answers

Part 1

1. a. true
2. b. false
3. a. true
4. a. true

Part 2

1. d. drama
2. c. Scenes that included both Wasikowska and Fassbender.
3. d. four stars out of five

Part 3

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

Claims	Supporting Details
This version will undoubtedly rise to the top of the heap in that debate.	Cary Fukunaga's emphasis on the Gothic elements of the novel elevates this adaptation to the top of the heap.
The movie condenses far too much of the book, and the ending is quite abrupt.	none
It is a bit dark in places.	Remember that this is a Gothic romance novel.
The cinematography of the English countryside is exceptional.	none
The development of the characters is a bit lacking.	due to the fact that the movie cut so much from the book

1. The reviewer does make a number of unsupported claims. However, there are more supported claims about the characters and the costumes which are convincing.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Movie Review

Part 4

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

1. The reviewer does include five specific events of the plot. These include Jane's childhood, her time at Lowood, and two visits. The reviewer does not reveal the ending other than that it is abrupt.
2. The review is written in an enthusiastic and positive tone and in a rather casual but informative style.
3. The reviewer states: "I have watched all 25 film adaptations and have read *Jane Eyre* numerous times as well as all of Charlotte Bronte's books."
4. The reviewer did not include the rating, nothing about how the music supports the Gothic mood of the movie, or how long the movie is.
5. I would like to know which important parts of the novel were cut out that should have been included in this adaptation.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 9–12

Movie Review

Part 5

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the writing.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Music Review

Answers

Part 1

1. a. true
2. b. false
3. b. false
4. b. false
5. a. true

Part 2

1. b. country
2. c. “If I Die Young”
3. b. “Lasso”
4. c. three stars out of five

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 9–12

Music Review

Part 3

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

Claims	Supporting Details
The sibling trio brings freshness to the country music scene that hasn't been heard for a long time.	none
This is an incredible example of original music.	The Band Perry's debut features producers Nathan Chapman and Paul Worley, who resisted the urge to pump up their sound on this pop-country effort.
The band walks the line between country-pop and traditional country and pull it off.	The track "Double Heart" mixes in a few rock elements with country music, and the results are interesting.
There's a track for just about anyone here.	The reviewer supports this with classifying the music into three major categories.
The CD is a great start for such a young band.	It is well-written and executed throughout. Kimberly Perry's voice is a lovely mix of sweet and salty. With fresh, vibrant instrumentation, the brothers also blend in vocal harmonies of pros.

1. The reviewer makes numerous supported claims. Only one of the claims is not supported. I am not a country fan but this review makes me curious enough to want to purchase the CD.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 9–12
Music Review

Part 4

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

1. The reviewer describes 7 of the 11 tracks on the CD which is just enough to create interest in the reader. The review discusses specific details of why one of the songs is the best and why one of the songs just doesn't appeal to the reviewer. The other tracks reviewed have just enough description to be interesting.
2. The review is written in an enthusiastic and positive tone. The style is rather casual but informative.
3. The reviewer does not clearly establish his or her credibility. I can assume that the reviewer had been listening to country and pop previously, but there are no specific references to anything.
4. The reviewer did not include the number of tracks, total playing time, any possible awards, and if any singles were released.
5. I would like to know how this CD has changed The Band Perry and how long they had been performing prior to this CD. It would also be more convincing to buy if I knew where it is on the country charts.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 9–12

Music Review

Part 5

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the writing.

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Answers

Part 1

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

1. a story about a person who steals and gets caught in the end
2. a story about people who have many struggles together but they keep working together as a team and finally achieve their goals
3. a story of a student whose parents have told her that if there is something that is wrong, she should let others know that what they are doing is wrong
4. a poem with a character of a little animal that helps others
5. a fable with a character of a person who learns that not doing what you say you are going to do makes people not believe in him

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Part 2

Student responses may vary. Acceptable answers include:

1. The theme is that despite how bad things might get, if you help each other you can endure and overcome evil.
2. The first folktale only has one example of working together while the second folktale shows many examples of working together and enduring and overcoming evil. Both folktales show the children overcoming the evil of the witch.
3. The style of the first folktale is shorter and is more violent than the second. The second folktale develops the plot and the characters more completely. Both tales include suspense, good, and evil.
4. Both of the tales include poverty, peasants, living in the woods or in the countryside, and magical characters such as a fairy and a talking cat. These provide the reader with a feeling for the cultural basis of the tale. The second tale includes words and names that are from the Russian culture.
5. I liked the second folktale better since it was less violent and seems to develop a second theme of kindness and goodness more than the first folktale.
6. These folktales are similar to Hansel and Gretel.

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Part 3

Student responses may vary. Use the following 3-point rubric to evaluate the student's writing.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Structure of a Folktale	Develops the Folktale Based on Appropriate Cultural References	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the structure of a folktale exactly.	Develops the folktale based on appropriate cultural references.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the folktale.
2	Does a good job of targeting the structure of the folktale but wanders a bit.	Partially develops the folktale based on appropriate cultural references.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the folktale.
1	Does not address the structure of the folktale at all.	Does not develop the folktale based on appropriate cultural references.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the folktale.